

Canon LBP 5300

No complaints!

Colour laser printer prices have never been this low, and the downward slide continues. The LBP 5300 from Canon is an economical printer for high-volume printing.

Build quality is very good, and the printer is more than suited for daily office work. At 22 kg, it is pretty heavy. It is also a bit bulky—a bit wider than a 19-inch CRT and taller than an average PC cabinet, but this size is to be expected of a colour laser printer.

The standard input paper tray has a capacity of 350 sheets, while the optional paper tray can accommodate up to 500 sheets. Duplex printing is supported. The device connects to the PC via the USB 2.0 interface, and also features a network interface—10Base-T / 100Base-TX. The bundled NetSpot

Device Installer makes installing this printer on a network straightforward.

The optical printing resolution is 600 x 600 dpi, and when we tested the device, both mono and colour prints are fairly sharp. Text was legible at all point sizes, and colour graphics were free from the artefacts typical of laser printers. A mono text document at normal quality took us 11.6 seconds to print, while a complex colour document took 14.5 seconds—pretty good by any standard. We logged a sustained pages per minute rate at a good 17.

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



This isn't really meant for photo printing, but we tried printing an A4-size photo; it took 16.8 seconds, which again is very good. The warm-up time is about 43 seconds.

The LBP 5300 comes with software for Windows, Mac, and Linux. It consumes 415 W during operation and 45 W during standby, and just 13 W in energy save mode.

Specifications

Printer resolution: 600 x 600 dpi (optical), 9600 x 600 dpi

(enhanced); Printer language: Canon Advanced Printing Technology (CAPT); Input tray capacity: 350 (standard), 500 (optional); Interface: USB 2.0, 10/100 LAN; OS Support: Windows, MAC, Linux; Memory: 16 MB SDRAM; Weight: 22 kg; Dimensions: 412 mm x 453mm x 437.7mm (W x D x H)

Contact: Canon India Private Ltd.
Phone: 1800-345-33-66
E-mail: info@canon.co.in
Web site: www.canon.com
Price: Rs 65,995

Kingston DataTraveler Secure Privacy Edition 8 GB

Spacious, secure, sturdy

USB capacity wars are raging hot. Now memory giant Kingston has upped the ante, introducing the 8 GB DataTraveler Secure Privacy Edition.

The drive is dark grey with black rubber piping for grip; it will weather dusty Indian conditions with ease. The cap fits snugly—no surprise, since the drive is supposed to be waterproof up to a depth of 4 metres. It comes with a detachable mini lanyard (the threaded string) to be fastened to a key-ring, but Kingston does not provide a key ring or anchor.

This is essentially a high-speed Flash drive for the extremely security-conscious; this is evident when you plug it in for the first time. You are greeted with a screen where you set a username, password, and password reminder hint.

Kingston seems to be a little too paranoid here: only after setting a very "strong" (as in complex) password can you access the drive.

The DataTraveler supports 256-bit AES encryption on the fly, that is, data is encrypted as it is being transferred to the drive. Considering this, the drive is quite speedy in its class of drives. When we tested it, it took just 57 seconds to write a 700 MB sequential file to the drive, and a much lower 30

seconds to read the same file from the drive. Assorted files of the same capacity take much longer, though: over 2:30 minutes to write to the drive while reading them takes 1:15 minutes.

You'll find Windows' Vista ReadyBoost feature supported; this

can't carry around files such as DVD images, which are generally larger.

Price? A premium Rs 12,000. We'd suggest waiting for a few months; it is probably too early to buy this one.



lets the OS use the drive as cache or virtual memory to enhance system performance.

In case you're totally taken in by the 8 GB figure, bear in mind that the drive only supports FAT32, thereby limiting the maximum individual file size to 4 GB. This means you

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of Use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Specifications

Capacity: 8 GB; Interface: USB 2.0; Password protection; Lanyard

Contact: Kingston India Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 1800-425-4515
E-mail: techsupport_india@kingston.com
Web site: www.kingston.com
Price: Rs 12,000